Class 10 SST – Chapter 2: Nationalism in India

🌟 Introduction to the Chapter

This chapter explores how the sense of modern nationalism in India was deeply connected to the anti-colonial movement. It details the emergence of Mahatma Gandhi, his novel idea of Satyagraha, and the various massive non-violent movements that united a highly diverse nation against British rule.

📌 The Idea of Satyagraha

Gandhi returned to India from South Africa in January 1915. He brought with him a novel method of mass agitation: **Satyagraha** (the power of truth).

- It suggested that if the cause was true, physical force was not necessary to fight the oppressor.
- A satyagrahi could win the battle through non-violence and appealing directly to the conscience of the oppressor.

Three Initial Satyagraha Movements:

1. **Champaran (1917):** To inspire peasants to struggle against the oppressive plantation system.
2. **Kheda (1917):** To support peasants demanding revenue collection relaxation due to crop failure.
3. **Ahmedabad (1918):** To intervene in a dispute between cotton mill workers and mill owners.

⚡ The Rowlatt Act and Jallianwala Bagh

The Rowlatt Act (1919)

The Imperial Legislative Council hurriedly passed this Act despite Indian opposition. It gave the government enormous powers to repress political activities and allowed detention of political prisoners without trial for two years.

The Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (13 April 1919)

- A large crowd gathered in the enclosed ground of Jallianwala Bagh (Amritsar) to attend the annual Baisakhi fair.
- General Dyer entered the area, blocked the exit points, and opened fire on the peaceful crowd, killing hundreds.
- **Dyer's Goal:** To produce a "moral effect" and create a feeling of terror in the minds of the satyagrahis.

❌ Common Mistakes to Avoid

> [!WARNING]
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> 1. **Khilafat Movement Confusion:** Remember that the Khilafat Movement was launched to defend the temporal powers of the Ottoman Emperor (the Khalifa), and Gandhi saw this as an opportunity to violently bring Hindus and Muslims together seamlessly under the umbrella of a unified national movement.
> 2. **Civil Disobedience vs Non-Cooperation:** Non-Cooperation (1920) meant simply *refusing to cooperate* with the British. Civil Disobedience (1930) went a step further—it meant *actively breaking colonial laws* (like the Salt Law).

📝 Quick Revision

The Salt March (Dandi March)

Gandhi found in salt a powerful symbol that could unite the nation, as it was consumed by both the rich and the poor.

- **The March:** Accompanied by 78 trusted volunteers, Gandhi marched 240 miles from his Sabarmati ashram to the coastal town of Dandi.
- **The Climax:** On 6 April 1930, he ceremonially broke the salt law by boiling seawater, explicitly marking the glorious beginning of the Civil Disobedience Movement!

> [!TIP] History is about timelines natively. Always memorize the chronological order of these events: Champaran $\rightarrow$ Rowlatt Act $\rightarrow$ Jallianwala Bagh $\rightarrow$ Non-Cooperation Movement $\rightarrow$ Simon Commission $\rightarrow$ Salt March!